BEYOND RASOOLI

Website strategy, design direction & development requirements

Founder / creator	Abdul Majeed Rasooli
Website type	Personal media brand, editorial publication and video library
Core tagline	Look Beyond the Obvious.
Primary purpose	Publish short-form videos, researched articles, explainers and ideas in one owned platform.

The goal is to create a thoughtful, premium-feeling digital home for evidence-based ideas about psychology, human behaviour, the mind, decision-making and the science behind everyday life. The site should feel like an independent editorial publication—not a generic influencer landing page.

Document purpose: this brief describes the brand, audience, site structure, design references, content workflow and functional requirements. The developer should use it as the baseline for estimating, designing and building the website.

1. Brand and editorial direction

Brand name: **Beyond Rasooli** (keep this spelling consistently: Rasooli, with double “o”). The brand should be broad enough to grow from psychology and human behaviour into learning, ideas, science, technology and thoughtful business content over time.

Brand positioning

Beyond Rasooli explains the hidden science behind ordinary experiences. It starts with something people recognise—an awkward social moment, a memory, a habit, a decision, a bias or a strange everyday phenomenon—and asks: *Why does this happen?* It then explains the underlying research in clear, engaging language.

Tagline and supporting language

- **Primary tagline:** Look Beyond the Obvious.
- **Optional brand line:** Science • Psychology • Human Behaviour • Ideas
- **Brand promise:** Understand everyday life more deeply through evidence, clear explanations and memorable storytelling.

Editorial principles

- Evidence-led: use credible research, studies, books and expert sources; link sources on relevant articles.
- Accessible, not simplistic: explain technical ideas in plain language without distorting them.
- Curious rather than preachy: ask interesting questions instead of giving generic motivational advice.
- Honest about uncertainty: distinguish established findings from early evidence, debate or speculation.
- Original: do not copy another publication’s writing, design, scripts or visual identity.

Founder bio (draft)

“Abdul Majeed Rasooli is the creator of Beyond Rasooli, an educational media project exploring psychology, human behaviour, decision-making and the science behind everyday life. Through short videos and accessible articles, he turns research and unusual everyday questions into ideas people can understand and use.”

2. Audience, languages and content

Intended audience

- Curious people who enjoy understanding why people think, feel, remember, choose and behave the way they do.
- Students, lifelong learners and viewers interested in psychology, neuroscience, behavioural economics and practical learning.
- People who prefer concise, visually engaging explanations but may want to explore the research in more depth.

Main topic pillars

CONTENT PILLAR	EXAMPLES
Psychology & human behaviour	Habits, attention, memory, perception, emotions, social behaviour and everyday mental shortcuts.
Neuroscience & cognition	How the brain processes information; learning, focus and memory, with careful limits on neuroscience claims.
Behavioural economics & decisions	Cognitive biases, incentives, risk, choice, money decisions and why people act against their stated intentions.
Everyday mysteries	Familiar experiences explained through psychology or science—for example, noticing your name in a noisy room.
Learning & thinking	Study methods, common learning mistakes, critical thinking and how to understand information more effectively.
Ideas, science & society	Thought experiments and research-led explanations of social phenomena; keep the focus educational and non-partisan.

Languages

- **Pashto:** primary language for short-form videos, using Arabic script—not Roman Pashto.
- **Dari/Persian:** publish selected content where it fits the topic and audience.
- **English:** use for selected articles, professional profile content and future expansion.

The website should be designed for multilingual growth from the beginning. If a full translation system is too expensive for launch, build the content model so additional language versions can be added later without rebuilding the site.

Content formats

- Short vertical videos (typically 30–50 seconds; occasional 60–90 second explainers).
- Written articles and research-backed blog posts.
- Short explainers, “Everyday Mysteries” and “Watch & Understand” collections.
- Source notes, recommended reading and links to original research where practical.
- Future: newsletter, topic collections, downloadable reading lists or learning resources.

3. Visual identity and video style

Overall feel: a premium science / ideas magazine with cinematic video storytelling. Minimal, intelligent, calm and distinctive. Avoid the look of a generic personal portfolio, loud influencer site, template-heavy blog or flashy tech startup.

Design direction

- **Palette:** warm ivory/off-white backgrounds, near-black text, muted sage/green accents and subtle grey dividers. Keep contrast accessible.
- **Typography:** an editorial serif for major headlines paired with a clean sans-serif for body text, navigation, labels and metadata.
- **Layout:** generous whitespace, clear hierarchy, readable line lengths, restrained cards and strong editorial photography/stills.
- **Motion:** subtle transitions only; no distracting animation, autoplay sound or heavy effects.
- **Mobile-first:** most visitors will arrive from TikTok, Instagram, YouTube or Facebook on a phone.

Video and imagery direction

- The creator’s face should **not** appear in the videos. Build the visual identity around voiceover, cinematic B-roll, real-world details, environments, hands, objects, archival/illustrative imagery and carefully designed text.
- Preferred video feel: cinematic documentary, realistic South Asian settings and people where relevant, natural light, shallow depth of field, subtle film grain and restrained colour grading.
- Vertical-first video: 9:16, typically 24 fps, with captions/subtitles that remain readable on mobile.
- Use original or properly licensed footage, images, music and sound effects. Avoid unlicensed clips and misleading AI-generated “real” footage.

Homepage visual hierarchy

- A clear hero statement and one-sentence explanation of the brand.
- A featured video or latest story, with a visible play action.
- Topic categories / editorial pillars.
- Latest videos and latest articles in separate, clearly labelled sections.
- A featured “Everyday Mysteries” or “Start here” collection.
- About the creator, social links and a simple newsletter signup (if enabled).

4. Recommended website structure (sitemap)

PAGE	PURPOSE / CONTENT
Home	Brand introduction, featured story/video, topic pillars, latest videos, latest articles and social links.
Watch / Videos	A searchable, filterable video library with thumbnails, topic tags, language labels and individual video pages.
Read / Articles	Editorial index with categories, search, tags, publication dates, reading time and featured articles.
Everyday Mysteries	A recurring collection of relatable questions and the science behind them.
Topics	Landing pages for Psychology, Neuroscience, Behavioural Economics, Learning and Everyday Science.
About	Creator biography, mission, editorial principles and links to social profiles.
Sources / Reading list	Optional resource hub for books, papers, useful websites and references mentioned in content.
Contact	A contact form for collaboration, speaking, media, corrections and general messages.
Privacy & Terms	Privacy notice, cookie/analytics disclosure where applicable, terms and copyright/contact information.

Suggested navigation

Home | Watch | Read | Topics | About

Keep navigation short. Contact, Sources, Privacy and Terms can appear in the footer. Do not add empty pages just to make the site look larger; hide sections until they have useful content.

5. Functional requirements

The site must be easy for the creator to update without asking the developer to change code every time a video or article is published.

Content management system (CMS)

- Provide a secure admin dashboard with separate content types for Videos and Articles.
- Allow the creator to create, edit, preview, schedule and publish content.
- Support draft, published and scheduled states; allow unpublishing and editing old posts.
- Fields should include title, slug/URL, summary, body or embed, thumbnail/cover image, topic/category, tags, language, publication date, SEO title, meta description and source links.
- Support featured content and ordering/pinning selected posts on the homepage.
- Allow content to be filtered by topic and language.

Video publishing

- Preferred approach: embed videos from YouTube for reliable playback and reduced hosting/bandwidth costs; support YouTube Shorts where appropriate.
- Allow a video URL, title, description, thumbnail, transcript/captions, language and topic tags.
- Design for vertical 9:16 videos; do not crop the central subject or important on-screen text.
- Do not autoplay with sound. Provide clear play controls and a fallback thumbnail.
- If direct video uploads are required, developer must explain storage, bandwidth, transcoding, backup and monthly costs before implementing them.

Articles and source citations

- Rich-text editor with headings, lists, images, pull quotes, links and embedded videos.
- Support references / “Sources & further reading” at the end of an article.
- Display author, publish date, updated date when relevant, estimated reading time and related content.
- Use clean, shareable URLs and social sharing metadata.

Search, discovery and engagement

- Site-wide search across article and video titles, summaries and tags.
- Topic pages and related-content recommendations.
- Social profile links; share buttons are optional but should not clutter the page.
- Optional newsletter signup, with consent and a clear unsubscribe process.
- Contact form with spam protection and clear confirmation/error states.

6. Technical, accessibility and SEO requirements

The developer may recommend the stack, but should prioritise security, performance, maintainability and simple publishing over unnecessary complexity.

Technical expectations

- Responsive design for mobile, tablet and desktop; test common iOS and Android screen sizes.
- Fast loading: compress images, use modern image formats, lazy-load below-the-fold media and avoid oversized scripts.
- Secure admin authentication; strong password handling, role-based access if multiple editors are added, and protection against spam.
- HTTPS, regular backups, dependency updates and a documented recovery process.
- A staging/test environment before changes go live, if practical.
- Clear ownership: domain, hosting, CMS, source code repository and analytics accounts should be registered to/controlled by the founder.
- Provide handover documentation and a short recorded or live training session showing how to publish a video and an article.

SEO and discoverability

- Editable page titles and meta descriptions; descriptive URLs; canonical URLs where needed.
- XML sitemap, robots.txt and sensible indexing settings.
- Open Graph/social preview image, title and description for every article/video page.
- Structured data where appropriate (e.g., Article and VideoObject), without adding misleading fields.
- Accessible headings, descriptive alt text, keyboard navigation, visible focus states and sufficient colour contrast.
- Language metadata and correct language/script rendering for Pashto, Dari/Persian and English. Test right-to-left text carefully.
- Connect Google Search Console and privacy-conscious analytics only after agreeing what data is collected and disclosing it appropriately.

Performance and quality checks before launch

- Test forms, search, embeds, navigation, 404 page, page titles, social previews and mobile layouts.
- Check that Pashto and Dari text displays correctly, including right-to-left direction and mixed English terms.
- Check accessibility basics, broken links, image loading and page speed.
- Confirm backups, admin access and the founder’s ownership of all accounts.

7. Example content to feature at launch

These are examples to communicate the editorial direction, not a fixed publishing schedule.

- **The Sound of Your Name:** why your name can stand out in a noisy room. Explain selective attention carefully; avoid claiming the brain literally monitors everything equally.
- **Three Study Mistakes:** common habits that feel productive but can lead to weaker learning; explain retrieval practice, spacing and passive rereading with evidence and limitations.
- **Why We Misremember:** how memory is reconstructed and why confidence is not a perfect measure of accuracy.
- **Why We Follow the Crowd:** social influence, informational cues and belonging—without reducing every group decision to “blind conformity.”
- **Why a Price Changes What We Feel:** how framing and expectations can affect perceived value, while noting that effects depend on context.

A video/article page should ideally connect the short video to a deeper article, sources and related content. This turns a social-media viewer into a returning website reader.

8. Website and content references

Use these as references for structure, editorial quality or storytelling—not as designs to copy. The final identity should be original to Beyond Rasooli.

Behavioral Scientist — https://behavioralscientist.org/

Primary structural benchmark: research-led behavioural science, accessible editorial writing and topic-based discovery.

Vox — https://www.vox.com/

Reference for explanatory journalism, clear story framing and turning complex subjects into accessible explainers.

The Marginalian — https://www.themarginalian.org/

Reference for thoughtful long-form essays, reading culture and an editorial voice built around ideas.

Kurzgesagt — https://kurzgesagt.org/

Reference for making complex science understandable through deliberate visual storytelling. Do not copy its illustration style.

TED-Ed — https://ed.ted.com/

Reference for concise educational storytelling and connecting a central question to a structured explanation.

YouTube — https://www.youtube.com/

Video hosting and embed destination; use a channel page as the canonical home for full videos where suitable.

9. Suggested launch scope and developer deliverables

Launch with a polished, manageable first version. Build a strong foundation rather than adding complicated features before there is enough content to justify them.

Must-have for version 1

- Home, Watch/Videos, Read/Articles, Topics, About, Contact, Privacy and Terms pages.
- Admin CMS for publishing and managing articles and video embeds.
- Responsive layout, search or at minimum category/tag filtering, SEO fields and social previews.
- Pashto/Dari/English-ready content model and correct right-to-left support.
- Social links, contact form, analytics/search console setup by agreement, backups and security basics.

Possible phase 2

- Newsletter automation, reader accounts, comments, courses, paid membership or digital products.
- Advanced recommendations, multilingual translation workflow, podcast/audio section or downloadable resources.
- Direct video hosting only if there is a clear technical and financial reason.

Please ask the developer to quote separately for

- Design / UI and responsive implementation.
- CMS setup and content types.
- Hosting, domain, email, paid themes/plugins and other recurring costs.
- Maintenance, security updates, backups and support after launch.
- Any extra cost for multilingual/RTL functionality and direct video hosting.

Deliverables required from the developer

- A short sitemap and wireframes before full development.
- A visual design sample for the homepage and one article/video page.
- Working website, CMS access and source-code handover.
- A list of all third-party services and recurring fees.
- Publishing instructions and handover/training.
- A defined bug-fix period after launch and a clear maintenance option.

10. Suggested homepage copy

Headline: Look Beyond the Obvious.

Subheading: Psychology, human behaviour and the science behind everyday life—explained through short films, thoughtful stories and research-backed ideas.

Primary buttons: Watch the latest video | Explore the articles

About snippet: Beyond Rasooli explores the questions hiding in everyday life: why we remember, choose, learn, notice and behave the way we do. Each story starts with curiosity and follows the evidence.

Final note to developer: the website should be owned and manageable by the creator, work beautifully on mobile, support a no-face video format and make it easy to publish consistently. Keep the experience editorial, fast, accessible and ready to grow.

Prepared October 2026. Some feature choices—especially CMS, hosting and direct video storage—should be finalised after the developer provides a costed technical proposal.